MIGRATION THEORIES AND PATTERNS (INDIA)

MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL → PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL → RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP → DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION → MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX → SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g4 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL

MIGRATION CONCEPT FIREWALL | CHANGE IN USUAL RESIDENCE ACROSS A MEANINGFUL BOUNDARY | MOVEMENT INTO A COUNTRY OR RECEIVING REGION | MOVEMENT OUT OF A COUNTRY OR SENDING REGION | DATA RULE | PLACE OF BIRTH AND LAST USUAL RESIDENCE ANSWER DIFFERENT

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
MIGRATION → change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary	EMIGRATION → movement out of a country or sending region	MIGRATION → change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary
IMMIGRATION → movement into a country or receiving region	DATA RULE → place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions	IMMIGRATION → movement into a country or receiving region

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- MIGRATION → change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary
- IMMIGRATION → movement into a country or receiving region

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- EMIGRATION → movement out of a country or sending region
- DATA RULE → place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- MIGRATION → change in usual residence across a meaningful boundary
- IMMIGRATION → movement into a country or receiving region

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DATA RULE → place of birth and last usual residence answer different questions.

01

STAGE 01 PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL

PUSH-PULL-OBSTACLE MODEL | ORIGIN PUSH | JOB LOSS, CONFLICT, DEBT, DISASTER, SOCIAL PRESSURE | DESTINATION PULL | WAGES, SAFETY, EDUCATION, AMENITIES, NETWORKS | INTERVENING OBSTACLES | DISTANCE, COST, BORDERS, INFORMATION GAPS | AGE, GENDER, CLASS AND SKILLS SHAPE WHO ACTUALLY MOVES

ORIGIN PUSH → job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure

DESTINATION PULL → wages, safety, education, amenities, networks → INTERVENING OBSTACLES → distance, cost, borders, information gaps → SELECTIVITY → age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- ORIGIN PUSH → job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure
- DESTINATION PULL → wages, safety, education, amenities, networks

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- INTERVENING OBSTACLES → distance, cost, borders, information gaps
- SELECTIVITY → age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- ORIGIN PUSH → job loss, conflict, debt, disaster, social pressure
- DESTINATION PULL → wages, safety, education, amenities, networks

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SELECTIVITY → age, gender, class and skills shape who actually moves.

02

STAGE 02 RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP

RAVENSTEIN LAW STRIP | MOST MOVES | SHORT DISTANCE RATHER THAN VERY LONG DISTANCE | STEP MIGRATION | VILLAGE TO TOWN TO CITY TO METROPOLIS | EACH MAJOR FLOW GENERATES SOME REVERSE MOVEMENT | USE AS AN ANALYTICAL GUIDE, NOT AS AN ABSOLUTE

MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance → STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis → COUNTER-STREAM → each major flow generates some reverse movement → LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance
- STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- COUNTER-STREAM → each major flow generates some reverse movement
- LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- MOST MOVES → short distance rather than very long distance
- STEP MIGRATION → village to town to city to metropolis

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → use as an analytical guide, not as an absolute rule.

03

STAGE 03 DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION

DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION | DISTANCE RISES | COST, UNCERTAINTY AND SOCIAL RISK RISE | OPPORTUNITY NODES | NEARER TOWNS INTERCEPT PART OF THE FLOW | REDUCE COST AND KEEP CORRIDORS ALIVE | MANY MIGRANTS MOVE IN STAGES RATHER THAN ONE LEAP

DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise → OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow → NETWORKS → reduce cost and keep corridors alive → RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
- OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- NETWORKS → reduce cost and keep corridors alive
- RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- DISTANCE RISES → cost, uncertainty and social risk rise
- OPPORTUNITY NODES → nearer towns intercept part of the flow

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → many migrants move in stages rather than one leap.

04

STAGE 04 MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX

MIGRATION STREAM MATRIX | MARRIAGE, LOCAL FARM LABOUR, NEARBY RELOCATION | LABOUR, SERVICES, EDUCATION, CONSTRUCTION | PROFESSIONAL, BUSINESS AND HIGHER-EDUCATION MOBILITY | RETURN MIGRATION, RETIREMENT OR PERI-URBAN SPILLOVER

CLASSIFICATION	DIAGNOSTIC BASIS	PROCESS LINK	EXAM TRAP
RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation	URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility	RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation	URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility
RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction	URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover	RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction	URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover

CLASSIFICATION
- RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
- RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

DIAGNOSTIC BASIS
- URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility
- URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover

PROCESS LINK
- RURAL-RURAL → marriage, local farm labour, nearby relocation
- RURAL-URBAN → labour, services, education, construction

EXAM TRAP
- URBAN-URBAN → professional, business and higher-education mobility
- URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: URBAN-RURAL → return migration, retirement or peri-urban spillover.

05

STAGE 05 SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET

SOURCE-DESTINATION BALANCE SHEET | REDUCED PRESSURE, REMITTANCES, BUT LOSS OF YOUNG WORKERS | LABOUR GAIN, MARKET EXPANSION, BUT SERVICE PRESSURE | AGE-SEX EFFECT | SELECTIVE MIGRATION ALTERS BOTH ENDS DIFFERENTLY | MIGRATION REDISTRIBUTES BOTH OPPORTUNITY AND VULNERABILITY

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers	AGE-SEX EFFECT → selective migration alters both ends differently	SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure	VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability	DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
- DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- AGE-SEX EFFECT → selective migration alters both ends differently
- VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- SOURCE → reduced pressure, remittances, but loss of young workers
- DESTINATION → labour gain, market expansion, but service pressure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → migration redistributes both opportunity and vulnerability.

06

STAGE 06 INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT

INDIA OFFICIAL SNAPSHOT | ALL-INDIA RATE | 28.9% IN MOSPI MIGRATION IN INDIA 2020-21 | RURAL RATE | URBAN RATE | LABEL THE SOURCE-YEAR BEFORE USING ANY PERCENTAGE

RURAL RATE → 26.5%	URBAN RATE → 34.9%
INTRASTATE → 87.5%	INTERSTATE → 12.5%

SYSTEM / DEFINITION
- ALL-INDIA RATE → 28.9% in MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21
- RURAL RATE → 26.5%

PROCESS / MECHANISM
- URBAN RATE → 34.9%
- INTRASTATE → 87.5%

SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN
- INTERSTATE → 12.5%
- RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage

HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE
- ALL-INDIA RATE → 28.9% in MoSPI Migration in India 2020-21
- RURAL RATE → 26.5%

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → label the source-year before using any percentage.

07

STAGE 07 MARRIAGE MIGRATION DOMINANCE

MARRIAGE MIGRATION DOMINANCE | FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE | 86.8% IN MOSPI 2020-21 | ANALYTICAL RESULT | RAW MIGRATION TOTALS ARE NOT EQUAL TO LABOUR MIGRATION | RURAL-RURAL STREAM | REMAINS LARGE BECAUSE MARRIAGE MOBILITY IS LARGE | EXAM USE

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS	TRIGGER / MECHANISM	EFFECT / INTERVENTION
FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21	RURAL-RURAL STREAM → remains large because marriage mobility is large	FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration	EXAM USE → separate social migration from labour migration explicitly	ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
- ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- RURAL-RURAL STREAM → remains large because marriage mobility is large
- EXAM USE → separate social migration from labour migration explicitly

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- FEMALE MIGRANTS DUE TO MARRIAGE → 86.8% in MoSPI 2020-21
- ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANALYTICAL RESULT → raw migration totals are not equal to labour migration.

08

STAGE 08 INDIA CORRIDOR MAP

INDIA CORRIDOR MAP | SENDING BELTS | BIHAR, UTTAR PRADESH, ODISHA AND EAST-CENTRAL REGIONS | GAINER ZONES | MAHARASHTRA, GUJARAT, DELHI, HARYANA AND PUNJAB | CURRENT LOGIC | LABOUR MOVES TOWARD INDUSTRIAL, FARM AND SERVICE CORRIDORS | THE SAME CORRIDOR MAY MIX OPPORTUNITY AND DISTRESS MIGRATION

SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions

GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab → CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors → QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

SYSTEM / DEFINITION
- SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
- GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

PROCESS / MECHANISM
- CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors
- QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

SPATIAL / INDIA PATTERN
- SENDING BELTS → Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Odisha and east-central regions
- GAINER ZONES → Maharashtra, Gujarat, Delhi, Haryana and Punjab

HAZARD / LIMIT / RESPONSE
- CURRENT LOGIC → labour moves toward industrial, farm and service corridors
- QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFIER → the same corridor may mix opportunity and distress migration.

09

STAGE 09 CIRCULAR MIGRATION AND UNDERCOUNT

CIRCULAR MIGRATION AND UNDERCOUNT | SEASONAL MOVEMENT | BRICK KILNS, HARVESTING, CONSTRUCTION, INFORMAL WORK | USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA | CAN MISS REPEATED SHORT-DURATION MOBILITY | POLICY EFFECT | PORTABILITY OF WELFARE BECOMES A MAJOR ISSUE | CITY EFFECT

SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work → USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility → POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue → CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work
- USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- POLICY EFFECT → portability of welfare becomes a major issue
- CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- SEASONAL MOVEMENT → brick kilns, harvesting, construction, informal work
- USUAL-RESIDENCE DATA → can miss repeated short-duration mobility

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CITY EFFECT → rental insecurity and service pressure stay concentrated.

10

STAGE 10 LARGE-CITY ATTRACTION LOGIC

LARGE-CITY ATTRACTION LOGIC | DIVERSE JOB SET | BIG CITIES OFFER MULTIPLE LABOUR-MARKET ENTRY POINTS | EARLIER MIGRANTS LOWER COST AND RISK FOR LATER MIGRANTS | TRANSPORT + SERVICES | LARGE NODES COMPRESS SEARCH COSTS | SOME NEARER TOWNS INTERCEPT FLOWS AS OPPORTUNITIES EXPAND

DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points → NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants → TRANSPORT + SERVICES → large nodes compress search costs → COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points
- NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- TRANSPORT + SERVICES → large nodes compress search costs
- COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- DIVERSE JOB SET → big cities offer multiple labour-market entry points
- NETWORKS → earlier migrants lower cost and risk for later migrants

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COUNTERPOINT → some nearer towns intercept flows as opportunities expand.

11

STAGE 11 MIGRATION ANSWER SPINE

MIGRATION ANSWER SPINE | RESIDENCE RULE, STREAM TYPE AND WHETHER MIGRATION IS INTERNAL | PUSH, PULL, OBSTACLES, DISTANCE-DECAY AND STEP MIGRATION | MARRIAGE-HEAVY RURAL-RURAL AND LABOUR-HEAVY CORRIDOR MOVEMENTS IN INDIA | INTRASTATE DOMINANCE, REMITTANCES, UNDERCOUNT AND VERIFIED PYQ ROUTING

DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international → EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration → MAP → marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India → QUALIFY → intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing

DEFINITION / COMPONENTS
- DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
- EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

TRIGGER / MECHANISM
- MAP → marriage-heavy rural-rural and labour-heavy corridor movements in India
- QUALIFY → intrastate dominance, remittances, undercount and verified PYQ routing

EFFECT / INTERVENTION
- DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international
- EXPLAIN → push, pull, obstacles, distance-decay and step migration

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DEFINE → residence rule, stream type and whether migration is internal or international.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | TODAY THE BROAD LOGIC STILL SURVIVES IN UPDATED FORM | CONSTRUCTION, SERVICE AND METROPOLITAN CORRIDORS ATTRACT LABOUR FROM LOWER-INCOME | DELHI NCR, THE MUMBAI-PUNE BELT, GUJARAT'S INDUSTRIAL CORRIDOR, PUNJAB-HARYANA AND LOGISTICS ZONES, AND BENGALURU-LED SERVICE REGIONS REMAIN HIGH-ATTRACTION | MIGRATION IN INDIA IS THEREFORE BOTH DEVELOPMENT-SEEKING AND DISTRESS-DRIVEN | THE SAME CORRIDOR CAN CONTAIN BOTH ASPIRATION AND DISTRESS | ONE WORKER MAY MIGRATE FOR SKILL-LED MOBILITY, ANOTHER FOR

OPTIONAL PROCESS DEPTH
- CAUTION: Today the broad logic still survives in updated form: industrial,
- construction, service and metropolitan corridors attract labour from lower-income agrarian regions.
- CAUTION: Delhi NCR, the Mumbai-Pune belt, Gujarat's industrial corridor, Punjab-Haryana farm
- and logistics zones, and Bengaluru-led service regions remain high-attraction spaces.

DATA / INSTITUTION LIMIT
- CAUTION: Migration in India is therefore both development-seeking and distress-driven .
- CAUTION: The same corridor can contain both aspiration and distress: one worker may migrate for skill-led mobility, another for survival.
- CAUTION: Rural-urban migration is not automatically a sign of successful structural transformation if urban jobs remain informal and insecure.
- CAUTION: Pandemic-era reverse migration made seasonal and circular labour mobility far more visible in policy debate.

CONTEMPORARY PARALLEL
- MoSPI / NSS / PLFS-based report: latest official migration survey snapshot.
- Census of India: long-run migration concepts, place-of-birth and last-residence tables.
- CAUTION: For answer quality, always distinguish census concept, survey concept and temporary/circular movement.
- Most migrants in India are intrastate, not interstate.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels